

FLAVOR APPRECIATION

When drinking tea, it may be difficult to distinguish between flavors. The “flavor wheel,” a visual representation of the distinct flavors and aromas found in teas, is a handy guide that will help you to understand and appreciate the intricacies of flavor.

Evaluating tea using taste receptors in the mouth and nose opens us up to a world of broad flavor profiles, here categorized into 12 groups. Each group can then be further dissected into descriptors that allow you to analyze facets of the tea’s flavors and characteristics.

Refer to the wheel after first smelling the aroma and then sipping the liquid infusion of the tea. Your first response will come from the inner wheel. For example: the green tea Bai Luo Chun (Green Snail Springtime) will immediately evoke vegetal, sweet, and nutty flavors.

Take another sip or sniff the wet leaves and look toward the smaller sections within this category. You may now detect the sweetness of corn in the vegetal category and the more specific flavor of chestnuts in the nutty section. Experimentation and experience will help you identify the flavors in any tea.

THE MORE YOU TASTE, THE EASIER IT IS TO IDENTIFY FLAVORS

NUTS

Nuts define roasted and sweet flavors in all types of tea. They are good descriptors for the astringency of tea’s tannins.

